RONNIE BAILEY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Identity Security Architect | Machine Identity & Agentic AI Governance | Zero Trust

Identity security architect with 15 years of experience across federal agencies and Fortune 500 enterprises, including DHS, the U.S. Secret Service, and USPTO. Led enterprise identity security initiatives supporting over 30,000 users, with expertise in Zero Trust architecture, privileged access, and identity governance. Advises senior leadership on security strategy with a growing focus on machine identity and autonomous AI systems.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Enterprise IAM Program Director

iHeartMedia | 06/2025 - 06/2026

- Owned core identity security components across iHeartMedia's enterprise IAM program spanning a 30,000 user hybrid environment across iHeartMedia, Katz Media Group, Triton Digital, Premiere Networks, and subsidiary brands.
- Aligned security, IT, HR, and business stakeholders to drive identity maturity and risk reduction across a multi-subsidiary portfolio with no prior accountability structure.
- Governed cross-boundary identity and access for international business partners and third-party collaborators across Triton Digital's global operations spanning more than 50 countries, managing federation trust, entitlement scoping, and access lifecycle across non-employee identity populations.
- Defined and maintained the identity and access management ownership model and RACI framework, establishing cross-functional accountability across security, engineering, and business teams where none previously existed.
- Directed Conditional Access strategy and enforcement across a 60-policy estate aligned to Zero Trust, driving MFA enforcement, device compliance, and risk-based access controls at enterprise scale.
- Re-established enterprise identity governance and lifecycle controls across HRIS-integrated systems, restoring provisioning integrity and access governance across Entra ID and connected enterprise systems.
- Defined and drove enterprise authentication and federation standards across critical business platforms including Workday, Genea, and GCP-integrated systems.
- Established enterprise privileged access strategy, eliminating standing privilege and enforcing just-in-time access and credential governance across all administrative tiers.
- Delivered weekly identity risk reporting directly to the CISO, translating technical exposure into prioritized business decisions with clear ownership and measurable outcomes.

Threat Detection/Security Automation

LexisNexis / United States Patent and Trademark Office | 04/2024 - 06/2025

Public Trust Clearance

- Designed Zero Trust architecture aligned to NIST 800-207 with JIT provisioning and continuous authentication monitoring, adjusting access decisions in real time based on behavioral risk signals.
- Built behavioral risk evaluation models adjusting access decisions dynamically based on user activity and contextual identity signals.

- Led Azure security architecture aligned to NIST 800-53 and CIS standards, authoring Infrastructure-as-Code security policies that enforce baseline configurations and surface configuration drift in real time.
- Standardized identity and security controls across AWS, Azure, and GCP with centralized CSPM integration, delivering unified dashboards aggregating risk signals across all three platforms for executive visibility.
- Redesigned OneIdentity Safeguard deployment for enterprise-wide privileged access control, executing a full offboarding and re-onboarding of privileged assets and realigning session recording, account rotation, and access policies from the ground up.
- Integrated Auth0 to deliver OAuth2 and OIDC-based SSO across enterprise applications, supporting FedRAMP and NIST 800-53-compliant authentication workflows with certificate rotation and trust validation.
- Engineered threat correlation across CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender, Palo Alto, and Checkpoint, improving detection quality and reducing response time through intelligent alert triage and deduplication.
- Designed forensic response processes using Secureworks Taegis aligned to NIST 800-86, ensuring defensible evidence handling and investigation integrity.
- Translated complex architecture and security findings into business impact for executive stakeholders, enabling informed decision-making on risk and remediation priorities.

Identity & Access Management Architect

Kroger, Technology & Digital Department | 12/2022 - 02/2024

- Led identity provisioning for 32,000 users across US and UK operations while maintaining HIPAA compliance, implementing structured lifecycle controls and removing manual provisioning from the critical path.
- Built role-aware provisioning workflows adapting access based on job function and peer access patterns, reducing inconsistent access assignments and privilege creep.
- Implemented PAM using One Identity Safeguard and TPAM, enforcing just-in-time privilege elevation tied to ServiceNow approval workflows and significantly reducing standing privileged access.
- Modernized identity using Entra ID across 12,000 hybrid users, eliminating legacy access models and improving authentication consistency across applications.
- Integrated Ping SSO and MFA across more than 40 applications using risk-based authentication policies; behavioral analytics reduced password-reset volume while cutting unauthorized access attempts.
- Designed AKS workload identity solution eliminating static credentials in containerized environments through workload identity federation.
- Established continuous access certification processes using behavioral analytics to identify dormant accounts, excessive permissions, and separation-of-duties violations across 20,000 accounts.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon with threat hunting playbooks across a fleet of 2,000 endpoints, strengthening threat detection, visibility, and incident response capabilities.
- Deployed Varonis for file access monitoring and data classification, strengthening SOX and GDPR audit readiness through continuous policy validation.
- Streamlined Active Directory using RBAC and Conditional Access to reduce policy drift and improve access governance consistency.

Customer Identity & Access Management Architect

Homeland Security, OCIO / US Secret Service | 02/2022 - 12/2022
Public Trust Clearance

- Integrated identity across more than 100 federal systems using SAML, OAuth2, and Active Directory federation, supporting large-scale ICAM initiatives across distributed federal infrastructure.
- Positioned IAM as a core security control within Zero Trust strategy across federal environments, improving authentication assurance and access control.
- Led ISO 27001 certification for the DHS Information Security Management System, establishing governance frameworks and control validation processes adopted agency-wide.
- Migrated more than 50 systems to GCP under FedRAMP Moderate authorization, implementing continuous compliance monitoring and infrastructure-as-code security baselines.
- Enforced least privilege across serverless workloads using workload identity federation, with permissions adjusting dynamically based on runtime context.
- Implemented Saviynt across a workforce of 15,000 users enabling access governance, entitlement reviews, and separation-of-duties enforcement, dramatically reducing manual certification effort.
- Delivered security scripting using PowerShell and Python aligned to FISMA compliance, producing reusable modules adopted across DHS security teams.

Cloud Vulnerability Analyst

Accessia Health National Non-Profit Patient Assistance | 07/2021 - 12/2021

- Led vulnerability management aligned to NIST 800-53 and HIPAA across enterprise systems, prioritizing remediation based on exploitability, business criticality, and threat intelligence.
- Built audit-ready compliance reporting via PingFederate logs supporting SOX, GDPR, and HIPAA requirements with real-time dashboards for continuous authentication visibility.
- Deployed PingFederate and Citrix NetScaler supporting high-availability authentication services through failover and health monitoring.
- Designed credential vaulting and rotation for privileged healthcare accounts, eliminating static privileged credentials across the environment.
- Embedded security review into the infrastructure change process using policy-as-code frameworks, catching compliance violations before deployment rather than after.
- Managed certificate lifecycle across a portfolio of 150 domains ensuring continuous compliance and eliminating manual tracking overhead.

Privileged Access Management Security Engineer

Indivior Pharmaceuticals | 10/2019 - 07/2021

- Led enterprise PAM transformation, mapping more than 200 job functions into structured least privilege RBAC models to systematically reduce excessive access across enterprise applications.
- Deployed BeyondTrust PAM securing approximately 1,200 privileged accounts, enforcing SOX-compliant credential rotation, session monitoring, and audit controls while eliminating standing privileged access for routine operations.
- Designed adaptive access policies in Azure AD (now Microsoft Entra ID) with risk-based scoring that enforces access controls dynamically based on real-time threat intelligence and user behavior.
- Built privileged access workflows supporting just-in-time elevation, approval-based access, and administrative tier separation.
- Established centralized governance for privileged accounts across legacy systems and business units.
- Implemented BitLocker encryption with deployment and backup policies protecting ePHI across all endpoints in compliance with HIPAA requirements.
- Integrated Terraform guardrails using policy validation, enforcing compliance from deployment through runtime with continuous scanning and drift detection.
- Designed mobile device management using Microsoft Intune with enforcement policies for a distributed workforce, securing remote access without impeding productivity.

- Supported incident response through analysis of privileged account activity and identification of misuse patterns across enterprise endpoints.
- Briefed executive leadership on security risks, compliance gaps, and mitigation strategies, translating technical findings into business impact through data-driven risk dashboards.

Identity & Access Management Analyst

Wells Fargo Bank | 04/2019 - 10/2019

- Designed a Zero Trust-aligned IAM framework with risk-based access controls, applying continuous verification and intelligent policy recommendations driven by historical access patterns.
- Built consistent identity controls across AWS and Azure environments using infrastructure-as-code for policy synchronization across cloud platforms.
- Enforced FFIEC and GLBA requirements via SCCM and Office 365 with access controls and continuous compliance monitoring across the banking environment.
- Extended Microsoft Defender's remediation capabilities through orchestrated threat response workflows and intelligent alert correlation, reducing analyst triage time.
- Engineered progressive profiling workflows using ADFS with failover for customer-facing banking applications, adding intelligent session management and fraud detection capabilities.
- Maintained a user base of 12,000 accounts across hybrid environments through lifecycle workflows, ensuring timely access grants and revocations via HR system integration.
- Ran staff security education alongside phishing response workflows, significantly reducing incident response time through orchestrated investigation and remediation.
- Briefed upper management on cloud security risks and mitigation strategies using risk dashboards that provided actionable recommendations and continuous visibility into posture trends.

Customer Identity & Access Management Engineer

Wellsecured IT | 10/2015 - 01/2019

- Designed and implemented Zero Trust IAM frameworks across Azure, GCP, and M365, reducing standing privilege by over 70 percent across enterprise environments.
- Served as escalation authority for critical IAM failures including SAML trust breakdowns, authentication loops, certificate expirations, and provisioning outages. When support tiers could not resolve it, the problem came here.
- Built certificate lifecycle management processes for SAML, OIDC, and OAuth2 across more than 100 enterprise applications; proactive 60-day alerts and direct SaaS vendor coordination eliminated authentication outages entirely.
- Managed identity data integrity across Workday, Active Directory, and Azure AD, resolving sync failures and attribute inconsistencies that blocked joiner, mover, and leaver processes across the hybrid identity stack.
- Integrated Splunk with IAM tooling for security event monitoring and alerting, achieving ISO/IEC 27001 and NIST 800-53 compliance through centralized log correlation and threat detection.
- Delivered Auth0 integration for client-facing financial services portals, building intelligent authentication that balanced security requirements with user experience at scale.
- Implemented OAuth 2.0 and OpenID Connect with token lifecycle management for cloud-native application APIs and microservices architectures.
- Built AWS IAM roles and encryption protocols across multi-cloud environments with policy enforcement ensuring consistent least-privilege patterns at scale.
- Stabilized fragmented IAM environments across enterprise clients with multiple identity providers and legacy system dependencies.
- Partnered with DevOps to embed log analysis and incident response directly into CI/CD pipelines.

Cloud Security Operations Lead

Cloudcentria Security | 06/2011 - 12/2015

- Built cloud security and identity programs from the ground up across AWS and hybrid environments, establishing foundational IAM controls, governance models, and policy-as-code frameworks aligned to NIST 800-53 and ISO 27001.
- Designed identity federation across SaaS platforms including Okta, Auth0, and application providers, resolving authentication failures and enabling centralized access control.
- Led forensic investigations establishing chain-of-custody processes for security incidents, including recovery of stolen intellectual property that established cloud forensics protocols adopted as industry practice.
- Delivered AWS security architecture including identity design, access enforcement, and continuous validation across IaaS, PaaS, and serverless deployments.
- Optimized Azure AD Connect sync logic and hybrid sync rules, normalizing attributes and UPN conventions to keep identity data consistent across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Administered BeyondTrust Password Safe with secret rotation and vault access workflows, eliminating credential sprawl through JIT tied to approved change management processes.
- Partnered with SOC teams during active incidents supporting containment, investigation, and remediation efforts including analysis of token misuse and privileged session activity.

SELECT ENGAGEMENTS

- Sr. Engineer, Machine Identity & Agentic AI Governance | Hearst Media (2026) — Served as the sole dedicated resource on a CEO-priority enterprise non-human identity governance program covering secrets, tokens, API keys, and AI agent credentials; authored governance documentation and managed vendor delivery across Identity, Security, Cloud, and Infrastructure teams.
- Nuclear Energy Cloud IAM Transformation | Westinghouse Electric Company (2024) — Implemented Entra ID and ADFS federation, MFA and Conditional Access, and PIM just-in-time administrative access for a nuclear-energy environment; integrated Sentinel and Defender for Cloud visibility.
- Identity Security Scoping & Standards | City of Chesapeake, Virginia (2024) — Defined identity security scopes and standards for municipal infrastructure, including tiered administrative access and RBAC. Conducted identity-focused forensic analysis and documented AI governance requirements to support implementation. Delivered identity-threat and privileged-access training.
- Federal ICAM Security Analysis | Department of Veterans Affairs (2023) — Reviewed ICAM controls and identity workflows, analyzed Azure Log Analytics data to identify control gaps, and tracked findings through remediation with named owners.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certifications

- CISSP (in progress, target 2027)
- Cisco Cybersecurity Essentials
- IBM Cloud Essentials

Education

- Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity, University of Richmond, Expected 2027
- Associate of Applied Science in Information Systems, Network Administration, Reynolds College, Completed